this case by simple string matching against the permission letters. For more complex cases, you might want to convert the permissions into a Java Set object and explicitly checking that all required permissions are contained in the set of permissions of the user.

> **TIP** The Java `EnumSet` class can be used to efficiently represent a set of permissions as a bit vector, providing a compact and fast way to quickly check if a user has a set of required permissions.

If the user does not have the required permissions, then you should fail the request with a 403 Forbidden status code. This tells the user that they are not allowed to perform the operation that they are requesting.

Listing 3.6 Checking permissions in a filter

```
  public Filter requirePermission(String method,
      String permission) {
    return (request, response) -> {    #A
      if (!method.equals(request.requestMethod())) {
        return;    #B
      }

      requireAuthentication(request, response);    #C

      var spaceId =
Long.parseLong(request.params(":spaceId"));
      var username = (String) request.attribute("subject");

      var perms = database.findOptional(String.class,
          "SELECT perms FROM permissions " +
              "WHERE space_id = ? AND user_id = ?",
          spaceId, username).orElse("");    #D
```